

SMART CITY AND DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION PROJECTS

Smart technology. Strong services.
Better lives for all communities.

Digital transformation is no longer only a future concept for municipalities. It is becoming a practical part of service delivery, accountability and planning. Smart city thinking is now being used to improve how municipalities track performance, communicate with residents, manage infrastructure and respond to service delivery problems.

A strong current example is the Gauteng Smart City Performance Monitor, a real-time dashboard launched to track key performance indicators across all 11 municipalities in Gauteng. The dashboard monitors areas such as governance, financial management, infrastructure delivery, climate resilience and disaster preparedness, while also giving residents access to municipal performance data.

This type of tool shows how digital systems can strengthen accountability. Instead of waiting for long reports after the fact, municipalities can use data to identify problems earlier, compare performance and give communities clearer visibility on progress.

Digital transformation is also changing citizen access to services. Municipal e-services, online billing, digital fault reporting, development application systems and customer portals can reduce queues, improve convenience and create better records of municipal

requests. The City of Cape Town's online services include access to municipal account services, jobs, licence renewals, development applications and fault reporting tools.

However, smart city development must not only benefit well-connected urban residents. Rural municipalities and smaller towns also need digital inclusion, better connectivity and simpler service platforms. The real test of digital transformation is whether it improves the experience of ordinary residents, especially those who have historically struggled to access services.

For municipalities, the smart city agenda should be practical: use technology to improve response times, track infrastructure, reduce corruption, modernise revenue collection and communicate better with the public. A smart municipality is not only one with technology. It is one that uses technology to serve people better.